CASE STUDY – 9

TITLE: CORPORATE POLICY REVIEW - CODE OF CONDUCT

Example: Wipro Limited

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1. INTRODUCTION:

Wipro Limited is one of the well-known IT services companies in India. It provides services such as software development, IT consulting and digital solutions. Employees play an important role in the success of a company, so they must behave honestly and responsibly. Wipro follows a Code of Business Conduct and Ethics that guides employees on professional behaviour, integrity and workplace responsibilities. This case study reviews Wipro's Employee Code of Conduct, explains its main rules, evaluates its strengths and weaknesses, and suggests improvements to encourage ethical behaviour and good corporate governance

2. POLICY OVERVIEW:

An Employee Code of Conduct is a set of rules that explains how employees should behave in the workplace. It helps employees understand their responsibilities and the company's expectations.

Wipro's Code of Business Conduct and Ethics focuses on honesty, integrity, respect, confidentiality and responsible business practices. It guides employees when they face difficult situations or need to make ethical decisions.

Objectives of the Policy:

- To encourage honesty and ethical behaviour among employees.
- To maintain discipline and professionalism in the workplace.
- To protect company and customer information.
- To prevent corruption, fraud and dishonest activities.

- ❖ To promote equal treatment and respect among employees.
- ❖ To avoid conflicts between personal interests and company interests.
- ❖ To ensure employees follow company policies and applicable laws.
- ❖ To provide ways to report unethical behaviour.
- ❖ To build trust among employees, customers and management.

3. KEY PROVISIONS OF THE POLICY:

Major Rules and Guidelines

- Employees should be honest and respectful.
- Company and customer information must be protected.
- Employees should not engage in bribery or corruption.
- Employees must follow company rules and laws.
- Personal interests should not affect company decisions.
- Employees should report unethical activities.

Employee Rights and Responsibilities

- Employees should behave professionally.
- Employees should respect their colleagues.
- Employees should protect confidential information.
- Employees should complete ethics training.
- Employees should cooperate with investigations.

Important Procedures

- Employees should understand the Code of Conduct.
- The company should provide regular training.
- Employees should report violations through proper channels.
- Management should investigate complaints fairly.
- Appropriate action should be taken against confirmed violations.

4. COMPLIANCE AND GOVERNANCE ANALYSIS:

Corporate governance means managing a company fairly, responsibly and transparently. The Code of Conduct helps employees follow ethical standards and company rules.

Laws and Regulations

- ❖ Employees should follow applicable laws and company rules.
- ❖ Company and customer information must be protected.
- ❖ Harassment and discrimination should be prevented.
- ❖ Employees should avoid fraud, corruption and conflicts of interest.

Legal and Ethical Compliance

- ➢ Employees should act honestly and responsibly.
- ➢ The company should follow applicable legal requirements.
- ➢ Employees should report unethical activities.

- Ethical practices help reduce legal risks and protect the company's reputation.

Governance Mechanisms

- Management should explain company policies clearly.
- Employees should receive regular ethics training.
- The company should provide proper reporting channels.
- Complaints should be investigated fairly.
- Policies should be reviewed regularly.

Accountability and Transparency

- Employees should take responsibility for their actions.
- Managers should follow ethical standards.
- Company rules should be applied fairly.
- Confirmed violations should be handled appropriately

5. POLICY EVALUATION:

Policy evaluation means checking whether a policy is effective and achieves its purpose. Wipro's Code of Business Conduct and Ethics provides guidelines for responsible employee behaviour.

Strengths of the Policy

- Encourages honesty and integrity.

- Promotes respect and professionalism.
- Protects company and customer information.
- Helps prevent fraud and corruption.
- Provides ways to report misconduct.
- Builds trust and protects the company's reputation.

Effectiveness and Practicality

- Helps employees understand workplace rules.
- Training supports better decision-making.
- Clear guidelines reduce confusion.
- Reporting channels help identify problems.
- Fair investigations improve accountability.

Gaps and Limitations

- Some employees may not understand all the rules.
- Employees may hesitate to report misconduct.
- Conflicts of interest may be difficult to identify.
- Lack of monitoring can reduce policy effectiveness.
- Online working may create information security risks.

6. BUSINESS RELEVANCE:

An Employee Code of Conduct helps employees work responsibly and protects the company's reputation.

Importance in Modern Business

- ❖ Promotes professional behaviour.
- ❖ Protects company and customer information.
- ❖ Creates a fair working environment.
- ❖ Reduces workplace conflicts.
- ❖ Supports business growth.

Impact on Employees and Management

- ➢ Employees understand their responsibilities.
- ➢ Managers can guide employee behaviour.
- ➢ Respect improves teamwork.
- ➢ Clear rules reduce confusion.
- ➢ Proper reporting helps resolve workplace problems.

Risk Management

- Helps prevent fraud and corruption.
- Reduces the risk of information misuse.
- Encourages early reporting of problems.
- Helps reduce legal and financial risks.

Ethical Practices and Corporate Governance

- Encourages honesty and fairness.
- Promotes transparency and accountability.
- Improves customer confidence.
- Supports responsible business practices.
- Contributes to long-term business success.

7. EXAMPLE: WIPRO LIMITED

Wipro Limited protects customer information by ensuring that employees follow confidentiality rules and ethical practices. For example, employees must not share customers' personal details or confidential business information with unauthorized persons. This helps Wipro maintain customer trust, prevent data misuse, and protect its business reputation

8. RECOMMENDATIONS:

- ❖ Conduct regular training on workplace ethics.
- ❖ Explain rules using simple language and real-life examples.
- ❖ Make reporting channels easy to access.
- ❖ Encourage employees to report concerns without fear.
- ❖ Apply company rules fairly to all employees.
- ❖ Conduct regular compliance checks.
- ❖ Provide training on data security and privacy.

9. CONCLUSION:

An Employee Code of Conduct is important because it helps employees understand their responsibilities and behave professionally in the workplace. Wipro's Code of Business Conduct and Ethics provides guidelines for honesty, respect, confidentiality and responsible business practices. It helps promote ethical behaviour, protect company information and build trust among employees and customers. Regular training, fair implementation and policy reviews can make the code more effective.

10. REFERENCES:

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